Codebook for trophy-taking and social complexity

Global analysis

Variable: Institutionalized trophy-taking
Dataset variable name: trophies
Description: Whether body parts are taken from enemies in an institutionalized or widespread manner, as a primary or expected outcome of war.
Original codes: yes (described in sources), no (described in sources as taboo or explicitly not practiced)
Codes for analyses: 0/1

Variable: Political expansion
Dataset variable name: expansion
Description: Whether warfare was conducted by society with the aim of increasing the territory or population under its political control. This should be roughly equivalent to the SCCS variable 909: 'Subjugation of territory or people' and the Seshat warfare variable of 'Annexation'. It indicates deliberate attempts to expand political control by a society's central authority but not decentralized expansion into land e.g. for hunting, grazing, or farming that involves fighting.
Original codes: absent/present
Codes for analyses: 0/1

Variable: time_period
Dataset variable name: mean
Description: The time period to which the other variables coded refer to, based on the date ranges covered by the sources referenced. For historical societies this generally is the start and end dates of a particular political organization, and may therefore be approximate. For ethnographically studied societies it is generally taken from the coverage dates given in eHRAF for the ethnographies used to code the other variables.
Original codes: Year range
Codes for analyses: average of time range, standardized (mean centered at 0, sd = 1)

Variable: Population size
Dataset variable name: pop.res
Description: Population estimates for each society at the date range being coded, binned according to the number of places.
Original codes: (0-99=1; 100-999=2; 1000-9999=3; 10000-99999=4; 100000-999999=5; 1000000-9999999=6;10000000-99999999=7; 100000000-999999999=8)
Codes for analysis: 1-5, standardized for input into PCA

Variable: Degree of political centralization
Dataset variable name: pol.cent
Description: How centralized is the society, based on Ethnographic Atlas variable 090 'Political integration') and Seshat variable 'Degree of centralization'.

Original codes: 1. acephalous (absence of any political organization, even locally; equivalent to EA090); 2. autonomous communities (local political integration transcending kin groups, includes societies coded under EA090 autonomous local communities and peace groups); 3. loose/nominal/minimal states (a central government with some control or authority over relatively autonomous regional rulers, equivalent to EA090 minimal states and Seshat nominal, loose polities); 4. confederated/feudal states (the central government has more control over regional rulers but not complete authority); 5. unitary states (as defined by the Seshat variable- regional governors are appointed and removed by the central authorities, taxes are imposed by, and transmitted to the center)
Codes for analyses: 1-5, standardized for input into PCA

Variable: Hierarchical governing levels
Dataset variable name: ext.hier
Description: Number of administrative/governing levels beyond the local community; roughly equivalent to Ethnographic Atlas variable 33 'Jurisdictional hierarchy beyond local community' generally used as a measure of political complexity in cross-cultural studies.
Original codes: Coded from 0 to 5 rather than the original 1 to 5 in EA033 to make code equal to the number of levels and to accommodate larger polities in the dataset. From description on D-place: 0 (=EA033 1, acephalous, no political authority beyond community, autonomous bands and villages); 1 (one level, small chiefdoms); 2 (two levels, larger chiefdoms); 3 (three levels, states); 4 (four levels, large states); 5 (my addition, five or more levels, empires). hier_source contains evidence and sources if not coded from EA033.
Codes for analyses: 0-5, standardized for input into PCA

Variable: Social complexity
Dataset variable name: PC1
Description: Overall measure of social complexity, PCA of population size, hierarchical levels, and centralization variables
Codes for analyses: first component from PCA of above variables, standardized (mean centered at 0, sd = 1)

Austronesian phylogenetic analysis:

Variable: "Jurisdictional hierarchy beyond local community (SCCS v 237)" in Pulotu
Dataset variable name: v48.polhier
Description: https://pulotu.com/compare/48#3/-11.70/149.06
Original codes: no levels, one level/district chief, two levels/regional chief, three levels/kingdom or state, four levels/empire encompassing multiple states
Codes for analysis: 1-5

Variable: "Agriculture / Horticulture"
Dataset variable name: v61.agr
Description: Pulotu variable 'Agriculture/horticulture' under Subsistence and Economy/Land-based means of subsistence
https://pulotu.com/compare/61#3/-11.70/149.06

Original codes: absent, minor, medium, major, principal depending on importance as source of food.
Codes for analyses: 1-4 for minor - principal (no societies coded as absent)

Variable: "Political Authority" in Pulotu
Dataset variable name: v88.polauth
Description: https://pulotu.com/compare/88#3/2.64/157.50
Original codes: Scope of political authority
Original codes: absent, sublocal, local, supralocal
Codes for analysis: 1-4

Variable: "Estimated population of largest political community" in Pulotu
Dataset variable name: v52.commpop
Description: https://pulotu.com/compare/52#3/-11.70/149.06
Codes for analysis: 1-5

Variable: Headhunting
Dataset variable name: headhunting
Description: Whether trophy heads/skulls were commonly taken during warfare with other societies. This is slightly different from the Pulotu definition of killing people for the purpose of obtaining their heads. The current definition is in keeping with the broader research questions of interest, which are concerned with the political and ecological correlates of institutionalized or culturally significant trophy-taking practices during war.
https://pulotu.com/compare/37#3/-11.70/149.06
Original codes: absent, present
Codes for analysis: 0/1